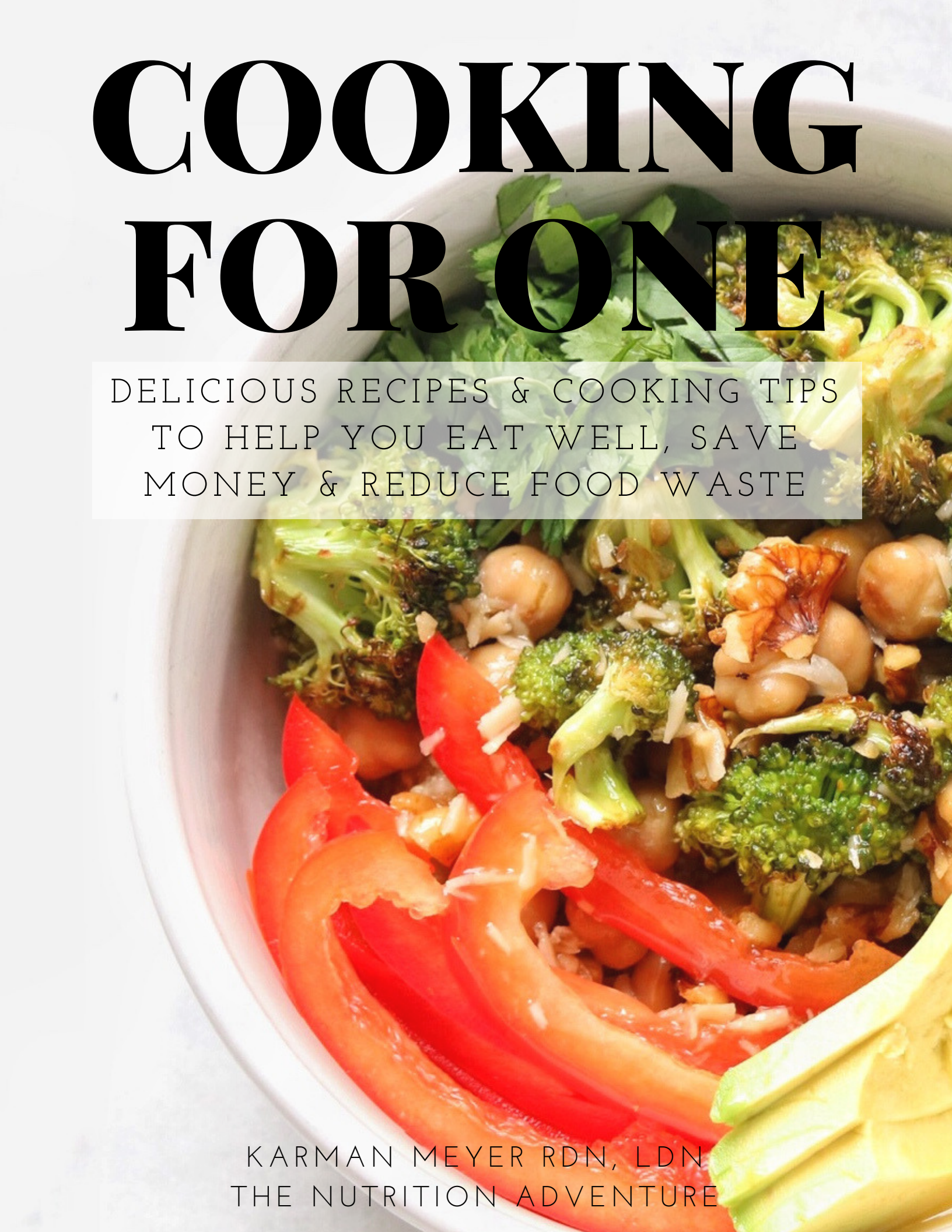


COOKING FOR ONE



DELICIOUS RECIPES & COOKING TIPS
TO HELP YOU EAT WELL, SAVE
MONEY & REDUCE FOOD WASTE

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THE NUTRITION ADVENTURE

COOKING FOR *YOU*

Thank you for downloading my
Cooking for One guide!

In my 8+ years as a Registered Dietitian, I've often heard, "It's impossible to cook healthy recipes for only one person!". Or this: "I always throw away so much food, it's cheaper to dine out or grab fast food".

It can be a challenge and may take time to adjust, but it's not impossible to cook healthy for one person! From my personal experiences cooking solo, I've learned what recipes and ingredients work, how to minimize food waste, and save money. Best of all, you won't have to eat the same thing for an entire week!

Let's get cooking!

-Karman



EAT WELL. SAVE MONEY. REDUCE FOOD WASTE.



COOKING FOR ONE: PRO TIPS

1. MAKE A PLAN

Planning at least 2-3 meals for the week is a big help when it comes to eating healthier and reducing food waste. Choose recipes that use similar ingredients so you can keep grocery costs down and minimize the amount of food you throw away.

2. RE-PURPOSE LEFTOVERS

Turning leftovers into new meals prevents boredom and helps save money. Have leftover chicken or steak from a previous meal? Turn it into tacos or make a wrap for lunch. Add leftover cooked salmon or veggies to an omelet for a quick & easy breakfast. Use leftover grains like rice or quinoa to make soup or add to leafy green salads. When I purposely plan to make 2 recipes for the week, I buy enough so I can also have 2 leftover meals.

3. KEEP IT SIMPLE

Buy frozen vegetables, fruits, or grains to save on prep time without sacrificing nutrition. Frozen seafood is also a great option. And don't feel like the recipes you add to a meal plan have to be super fancy—just make sure it's something you'll actually make & enjoy!

COOKING FOR ONE: PRO TIPS

4. TAPAS-STYLE DINNER

There's no shame in eating a meal pieced together with several different elements to create a 'tapas-style' experience. This traditional Spanish-style of eating is becoming more common in restaurants where groups order multiple small dishes and then share. You can create your own tapas-style meal by creating a plate with a few slices of different cheeses, crackers or sliced, artisan bread, a variety of meats like prosciutto, and then add some color with pickled vegetables and some fresh fruit like grapes or strawberries. You can get really creative with these tapas-style plates!

5. SINGLE SERVINGS & BULK BIN BUYS

These two things may seem like exact opposites but they both work well when buying for one because you can control how much you're getting. Head to the meat or seafood counter to buy individual portions or smaller amounts than packaged meats. For items like rice, nuts, snack mixes, or even chocolate-covered treats, scoop from the bulk bins so you can get only what you need.

6. FREEZE IT

There are endless freezer meal recipes out there so save yourself some time by cooking larger quantities and freezing some to use later.



COOKING FOR ONE:

Recipes



LEMON BLUEBERRY QUINOA BREAKFAST BARS

These bars are great to make on the weekend for an easy breakfast or snack option to have throughout the week. Makes 4 servings.

- | | |
|----------------------------------|---|
| 1/2 cup quinoa | 1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice |
| cinnamon | 1 teaspoon lemon zest |
| 1 1/4 cup gluten-free quick oats | 1/2 teaspoon vanilla |
| 1/4 cup shredded coconut | 3/4 cup fresh blueberries |
| 1/2 teaspoon baking powder | 3 ounces white chocolate chips, melted (if desired) |
| 1/4 cup granulated sugar | |
| 1/4 cup vanilla Greek yogurt | |
| 2 eggs | |

1. In a small saucepan, add quinoa with 1 cup of water and add a dash of cinnamon. Bring to a boil, then reduce heat to a simmer, cover with a lid and cook for 15-20 minutes, or until water is absorbed. Fluff quinoa with a fork and set aside to cool.
2. Line an 8x8 baking dish with parchment paper and preheat oven to 350 degrees F.
3. In a large bowl, combine cooked quinoa, oats, shredded coconut, and baking powder. Combine well.
4. In a small bowl, mix together sugar, Greek yogurt, eggs, lemon juice, lemon zest, and vanilla.
5. Pour the wet ingredients over the dry ingredients and stir until just combined. Fold in blueberries. The mixture should be moist but not runny.
6. Pour mixture into baking dish and bake for 25 minutes.
7. Remove from oven and allow to cool completely before removing from pan and cutting into squares. Drizzle with melted white chocolate chips once cooled, if desired.

SPRING ASPARAGUS QUICHE

These mini quiches make breakfast time feel special plus they're perfect when you have to bolt out the door! Makes 2 servings.

- 4 mini pastry shells, unthawed per package directions
- 8 asparagus stalks
- 3 large eggs
- 1/4 cup 2% milk
- 1 green onion stalk, sliced thin
- 4 pieces bacon, cooked and chopped well (optional)
- black pepper

1. Preheat oven according to pastry shell directions and place shells on a baking sheet. Set aside.
2. Cut the top 2 inches from each of the asparagus stalks and set aside. The remaining asparagus sections will not be used in this recipe.
3. In a medium bowl, whisk together eggs and milk. Add in green onion and bacon, if using, and black pepper.
4. Evenly divide egg mixture among pastry shells. Gently place two asparagus pieces on top of egg mixture for each quiche, forming an "X".
5. Bake for 15-20 minutes, or until egg is set in the middle of each quiche.

*To reheat: If the pastry shell is in an aluminum pan, remove it before placing in the microwave. Microwave quiche for 30 seconds and then enjoy!





GRAPEFRUIT SALMON SALAD

With a homemade citrus vinaigrette, fresh grapefruit and avocado, and perfectly cooked salmon, you'll look forward to eating this salad twice! Makes 2 servings.

Citrus Vinaigrette:

1/4 cup fresh orange juice (about 1 small navel orange)
 2 tablespoons fresh grapefruit juice
 2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil
 1 tablespoon minced cilantro leaves
 2 teaspoons white wine vinegar
 1 teaspoon fresh lime juice
 1 clove garlic, finely minced
 pinch of salt

For the salad:

2-6 ounce salmon filets
 1 teaspoon olive oil
 salt and pepper to taste
 1-5 ounce package baby kale + spinach mix
 1 grapefruit, cut into sections
 1/2 avocado, sliced thin
 1/2 cup shelled edamame, thawed
 1/4 cup red onion, thinly sliced
 2 tablespoons raw, unsalted pumpkin seeds

1. Prepare the citrus vinaigrette by combining all ingredients in a small mixing bowl or liquid measuring cup. Whisk together and set aside.
2. Prep the salmon filets by placing them skin side down on a plate. Pat with a paper towel to dry. Season with salt and pepper.
3. Heat a 10" skillet over medium-high heat. Once hot, add 1 teaspoon olive oil. Carefully place the salmon filets skin side up in the skillet and reduce the heat to medium. Cook for 4-5 minutes or until the salmon is cooked halfway through. Gently turn the salmon filets over and continue to cook for another 3-5 minutes. Once cooked through, place the filets on a clean plate. The skin should now be easy to remove in one piece using a pair of tongs or fork.
4. Prepare the salad by starting with the baby kale and spinach mix. Top with the grapefruit, avocado, edamame, red onion, and pumpkin seeds. Place one salmon filet on top of the salad and store the other in the refrigerator until ready to use. Reheat in microwave for 45-60 seconds.

CUCUMBER TARTINE

Lunch can be as simple as this no-cook Cucumber Tartine. Try it with your favorite vegetable toppings! Makes 1 serving.

1 slice sprouted whole grain bread
 feta cheese
 ricotta cheese
 cucumber
 truffle salt or pink Himalayan salt

1. Toast the bread in a toaster or toaster oven to desired doneness.
2. Mix together the feta cheese and ricotta cheese in a small bowl.
3. Spread the cheese mixture onto the bread and top with sliced cucumbers.
4. Sprinkle with salt as desired and enjoy.





ZESTY TUNA LETTUCE WRAPS

These Zesty Tuna Lettuce Wraps can be easily assembled in less than 15 minutes and make for a light and refreshing meal! Makes 1 serving.

5 ounces canned tuna, drained
 1/4 avocado
 1/2 tablespoon chopped cilantro
 1/4 teaspoon Dijon mustard
 1/4 teaspoon sriracha
 Black pepper, to taste
 4 Bibb lettuce leaves, rinsed and patted dry

Toppings:
 Shredded carrots
 Diced cucumbers
 Sriracha

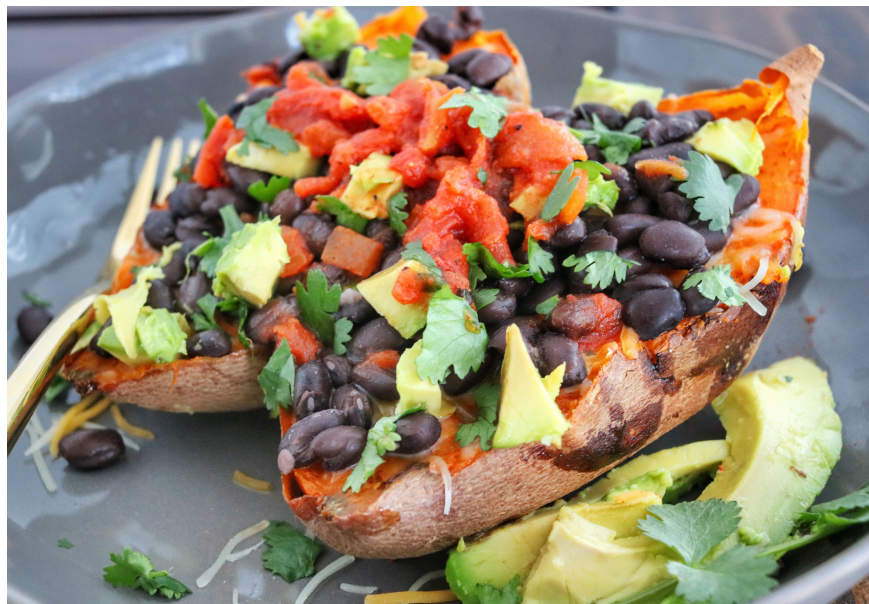
1. In a small bowl, combine the drained tuna, avocado, cilantro, sriracha, mustard, and black pepper. Mix well until no more chunks of avocado remain.

2. Wash and pat dry 6 Bibb lettuce leaves. Evenly divide the tuna among each lettuce leaf and top with carrots, cucumber and more sriracha if desired. Serve or store lettuce wraps in an air-tight container for up to 24 hours.

LOADED SOUTHWEST SWEET POTATOES

Go savory with your sweet potato by trying this recipe for Loaded Southwest Sweet Potatoes! Makes 1 serving.

1 large sweet potato
 Cayenne pepper
 1/4 cup shredded Mexican cheese
 4-5 ounces canned black beans, rinsed well
 Avocado
 Salsa
 Cilantro



1. Preheat oven to 400 degrees. Line a baking sheet with aluminum foil. Pierce the sweet potato several times with a knife and place on baking sheet.
2. Bake for 45-60 minutes or until you can easily pierce the sweet potato with a fork through the center.
3. Allow the sweet potato to cool slightly before cutting in half. Sprinkle a small amount of cayenne pepper over the sweet potato, then top with cheese, beans, avocado, salsa, cilantro, and other toppings as desired.



TROPICAL CHICKPEA QUINOA BOWL

The spicy roasted broccoli and coconut mango dressing make this vegetarian quinoa bowl unique and super flavorful! Makes 2 servings.

1/2 cup quinoa
1 cup water
4 cups broccoli florets
2 tablespoons olive oil
2 teaspoons sriracha
1 cup canned chickpeas, rinsed
1/2 cup chopped walnuts

Toppings:
1/4 cup Coconut Mango dressing
Red bell pepper, sliced thin
Avocado, sliced
Cilantro
Lime

1. Preheat oven to 450 degrees F. Spray a baking sheet with cooking spray.

2. In a small saucepan, combine the quinoa and water and bring to a boil. Once boiling, reduce to a simmer, cover with a lid and cook for 15-20 minutes or until liquid is absorbed. Fluff with a fork and remove from heat once cooked.

3. Meanwhile, whisk together the olive oil and sriracha in a small bowl. Add the broccoli florets to a large bowl and pour the sriracha olive oil over top and stir well to coat. Spread the broccoli onto the baking sheet and roast in oven for 10 minutes on the middle oven rack. Stir broccoli around on baking sheet and add the chickpeas and walnuts. Place back in the oven and roast for 5 minutes. Remove from oven and set aside in a large bowl.

4. To assemble quinoa bowls: add half the quinoa, broccoli, chickpeas, & walnuts to a bowl. Top with 2 tablespoons of the Coconut Mango dressing, sliced red bell pepper, avocado, cilantro, and a squeeze of fresh lime juice. Store leftovers in the refrigerator and add dressing and other toppings before eating.

TACO PITA PIZZA

Everything you love about tacos....on top of a pita! This is one of my reader's favorite recipes from the blog. Makes 1 pizza (you'll have leftover beef taco filling to make another pizza or tacos!).

1 pocket-less pitas
1/2 pound 93% lean ground beef
1/3 cup salsa
1/4 cup low-fat shredded cheddar cheese
2 tablespoons finely diced red onion
1 roma tomato, diced
1/2 avocado, sliced
1/2 cup shredded lettuce

Additional toppings:
Cilantro
Salsa
Sour cream or plain Greek yogurt

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees F. Place pita directly on to oven rack and heat for 5-7 mins. or until lightly browned. Remove from oven and keep warm by wrapping in aluminum foil.

2. Meanwhile, cook ground beef in a large skillet over medium heat until cooked through and no longer pink. Drain any grease. Return skillet to heat and add in salsa and cook for 2 minutes.

3. Prepare the taco pita pizza by placing the pita on a plate and topping with the cooked ground beef, shredded cheese, diced onion, diced tomato, avocado, and additional toppings as desired.



COOKING FOR ONE: 'NO-RECIPE' RECIPES

Cooking a delicious meal at home doesn't always require a recipe. These 'no-recipe' recipes are simple enough to throw together in under 20 minutes.

1. Quesadilla: tortilla, protein of choice, sauteed veggies, cheese, avocado & salsa
2. Avocado & White Bean Toast: sprouted whole-grain bread, mashed avocado, cannellini beans mixed with chopped herbs & tomatoes
3. Veggie Omelet: 2 eggs, sauteed veggies, fresh herbs
4. Rice Bowl: frozen brown rice, canned black beans or protein of choice, shredded cheese, salsa, avocado & cilantro
5. Savory Quinoa Bowl: cooked tri-color quinoa, protein of choice, sauteed veggies, fresh herbs, feta cheese or shredded cheese





COOKING FOR ONE: 'NO-RECIPE' RECIPES

6. Yogurt Parfait or Smoothie Bowl: smoothie or yogurt base topped with fruit, granola, seeds & coconut
7. Snack Wraps: whole wheat tortilla, favorite nut butter & sliced banana or your favorite fruit
8. Sweet Stuffed Potato: leftover baked sweet potato topped with your favorite nut butter, shredded coconut & cinnamon
9. Savory Stuffed Potato: leftover baked potato or sweet potato with corn salsa, black beans, cooked tri-color quinoa, guacamole & cilantro
10. Panini: choice of bread, cheese, veggies & a protein of choice

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